



Part I

Securing Apache

Targeted at readers with Web security concerns, information security experts, systems administrators and all those who want to jump-start their careers in Web security, this series of articles intends to cover the strengthening of Web applications and the Apache Web server framework, as well as any possible attacks against both.

With about a 54-56 per cent share of the Web server market, according to a survey by news.netcraft.com, Apache is the second most famous project in the open source world, after Linus Torvalds' Linux kernel. It is, indeed, a de facto standard for Web applications. However, because of the high market share, it has always been a hunting ground for attackers, and is still vulnerable to

many known and unknown malicious attacks. An unsecured Apache server can have a devastating effect on your website, the server as a whole, and also on your reputation, if your site is broken into.

However, the response to that is to secure our Web applications and Web server framework—and that's what we will be doing in this series. Starting with an introduction to Apache's architecture, we will look at the many